HOOK

The AI agent fight just moved past the model

Two competing standards dropped in the same news cycle

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Big players are racing to define how agents talk

Meta, Walmart and Stripe are backing one open agent standard. Sierra shipped its own Personal Agent Protocol.

- Two separate open standards announced close together
- Different companies, same underlying problem
- Nobody wants to build on someone else's lock-in

WHY IT MATTERS

The hard problem shifted from models to plumbing

Capable models are now common. Getting agents to work together isn't.

- Model quality is no longer the bottleneck
- Agents still can't reliably talk to each other
- Or call external systems in a consistent way

THE MECHANISM

What an agent standard actually defines

It's not about intelligence. It's about shared rules.

- How an agent identifies itself to other systems
- How it passes context, permissions, and state
- How tools and APIs get described so agents understand them
- How errors and handoffs are handled between agents

WHY FRAGMENTATION IS RISKY

Early protocol wars decide long-term defaults

Whoever wins adoption first shapes how everyone else builds.

- Two standards can coexist for a while
- But integrations usually consolidate around one winner
- Businesses building now are picking a side, knowingly or not

LESSON

This mirrors every past integration standard

APIs, webhooks, and OAuth all went through this same phase.

- Multiple formats compete before one becomes dominant
- The winner is usually the easiest to adopt, not the best spec
- Early builders absorb the migration cost later

WHAT TO DO NOW

Build the logic, not a bet on one protocol

You don't need to pick a side today. You need to stay flexible.

- Keep agent logic separate from the transport/protocol layer
- Favor tools and platforms with clear integration docs
- Design workflows so the protocol can change underneath them

TAKEAWAY

Interoperability is the real AI agent race now

Not which model is smartest, but which agents can actually connect.

- Watch which standard gets adopted by your existing tools
- Architecture decisions matter more than model choice
- The businesses that adapt early avoid costly rebuilds

CTA

Already building agent workflows?

Happy to compare notes on how you're structuring the integration layer.